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your ear. Some sets are sleek and will have the main body fit tuck securely behind your ear. Others have the main unit protruding from the earpiece. Irrespective of the design the unit should feel comfortable in your ear before buying a unit make sure to try it or if you cannot do that at least take a close look at it. If the earpiece region appears too large for your ears you may have a problem with its fitting and in such cases you'll be in discomfort – not worth it. Newer models have silicone earbuds that gently fit inside your ear and being soft can partially take its shape. These are more comfortable. Also look at the battery rating especially in case you need to use the headset for long hours. I've found Jabra and Plantronics handsfree units to be really neat in terms of comfort, build quality, voice clarity and ergonomics. Nokia's BT handsfree units are also pretty good although not as attractive looking as the other two brands.

For those interested in music look at stereo headsets. The Genius BT-02N is a foldable, supra-aural stereo Bluetooth headset that can be used for music and calls. Its got a lot of features tied into a single button and there are buttons for changing volume. However its priced a bit steeply – Rs 5,200 is expensive even for a stereo BT headset. Nokia has a few BT handsfree units that can double as mono headsets. The BH-101 is their basic model and supports BT 2.0 and EDR although A2DP is lacking therefore this is for taking calls only. Its priced well at Rs 1,090 and is compatible with a host of headsets. Nokia's BH-209 was also on display. The features are similar but this one is slightly sleeker and is priced at Rs 1,350. The Nokia BH-600 was also on display. Priced at Rs 2,600 this one has an armature that sits behind the ear making for a snug fit.

Mobile phone accessories

With our cellphone comparison happening we decided to take a look at all the other stuff a user could buy for his shiny new smartphone or PDA phone.

One of the widest used accessories is the wireless handsfree unit simply referred to as a Bluetooth handsfree. There is a slight distinction between a headset and a handsfree unit. A handsfree unit is something with a microphone built into it in addition to the earpiece to allow one to take and receive calls. Handsfree units often have call receive/reject and volume buttons on them. A headset typically refers to earphones

whether wired to wireless. A handsfree unit is very useful when you are engaged in any activity that requires use of both hands, for example a crowded bus, a local train, driving your car or riding a bike. In such cases its not always possible or recommended to reach for your cellphone in the even of receiving a call but the handsfree unit allows you to talk without ever needing to touch your phone. While wired sets are bundled with most cellphones, wireless Bluetooth handsfree units are hot at the moment. One of the most important things to consider when buying a Bluetooth headset is its compactness – you don't want something bulky sitting on

In terms of technology there are a host of compliances that both Bluetooth handsfree units and headsets should support. Ideally look for a device that supports Bluetooth 2.1 or 2.0. The former is the latest revision and supports even easier pairing and lower power consumption that increases talk time and stand by time. EDR (Enhanced Data Rate) should also be supported and this speeds up file transfers. Look for Handsfree Profile 1.5 (HFP 1.5) compliance. A2DP 1.0 (Advanced Audio Distribution Profile) is a must because it allows high quality music streaming from one Bluetooth device to another.

Its got the same feature list but uses inbuilt circuitry for noise reduction. Jabra has an even larger range of models and I came across their entry-level BT-125 and BT250V models. Both models have an armature going behind the ear although I found the earpieces to be slightly uncomfortable – a pity no padding material was used on the earbud although the BT250V does have a silicone tip that protrudes into your ear canal. Priced at Rs 1,630 and 1,500 respectively these models are fairly attractive looking BT 2.0 and EDR. Another very simple looking model, the Jabra BT-2050 was priced at Rs 2,250. It supports BT 2.0 but doesn't support either EDR or